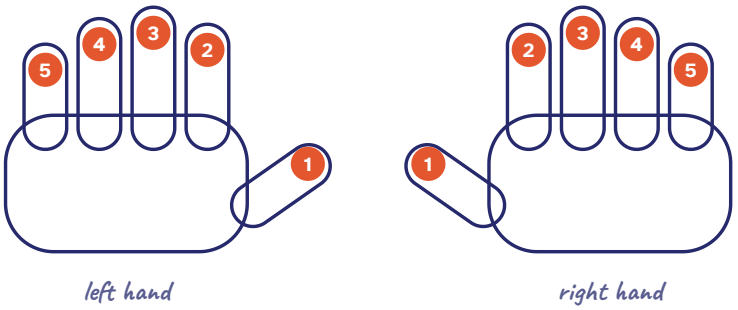
PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 1

Fingering

Good fingering makes hard passages easy and keeps your hand relaxed. It is planned, not guessed, and the plan starts with a number for every finger.
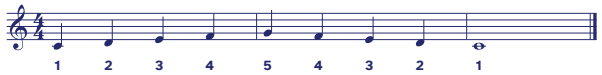
THE SECRET

Thumbs are 1 in both hands. Choose a fingering once, write it in, keep it.
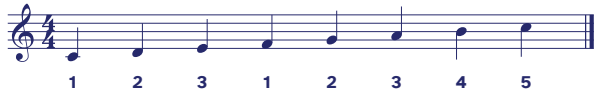


Thumbs are 1 in both hands

Five-finger position
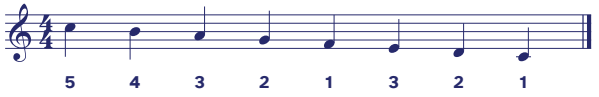


Thumb on C, one finger on each key up to G: five notes without moving the hand. Many first pieces stay in one position.

Thumb under, finger over



Up the scale: 1 2 3, thumb under to F, then 1 2 3 4 5.



Down: 5 4 3 2 1, then 3 crosses over the thumb.
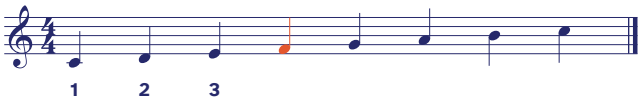
TWO-MINUTE DRILL Play C D E F G with each hand, saying the finger numbers: right 1 2 3 4 5 up, left 5 4 3 2 1 up. Then both hands together.

Left hand, C major up: 5 4 3 2 1, then 3 crosses over to A, then 2 1. **Down:** 1 2 3, thumb under to G, then 1 2 3 4 5.

PART VIII · PLAYING AND LISTENING · 1 · CONTINUED

EXAMPLE 1

Which finger plays the F?



?

1. **C D E** are 1 2 3.
2. **The F:** finger 4, or the thumb tucked under?
3. **Then** how do you reach the top C?

The **thumb** passes under to F; then 2 3 4 5 reach the top C.

EXAMPLE 2

Which finger plays G?

Right hand, thumb on C ?

1. **Thumb on C** is 1.
2. **Count up** one finger per key: D, E, F, G.
3. **So G** is…?

Finger **5**: C D E F G is 1 2 3 4 5.

GAME
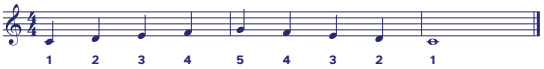
Name the finger

1 thumb	2 index
3 middle	4 little

Give the finger number.

Answer: 1 one · 2 two · 3 three · 4 five.

TRY IT · 10 SECONDS



Five fingers, five keys.

Right hand on C D E F G. Play up and down, saying the finger numbers aloud. Then the left hand: 5 4 3 2 1 from C up.

TRAP

- × Changing fingering every time you play: choose one, write it in, keep it.
- × Landing heavily on the thumb as it passes under: let it glide.

SEE ALSO

The keyboard p. 22 · Major scales p. 93

PRACTISE IT

Workbook pp. 1–2 · Online: Scales with fingering